Banking regulations

Some complaints don't involve securities, so the Federal Reserve System (the Fed) responds to problems with banks and other types of financial institutions. Other federal regulatory agencies include the OCC, FDIC, and the FASB.

The Fed and CFPB

The Fed investigates claims made by individuals who have been treated unfairly. Complaints can be filed on the Fed's website or by phone, mail, or fax.

The Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB), is an independent agency funded by the US Federal Reserve. The CFPB was created to protect consumers from deceptive and unfair treatment practiced by financial institutions, including banks, payday lenders, credit unions, mortgage lenders, and debt collectors.

OCC

The Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (OCC) is an independent bureau that operates within the US Department of Treasury. The OCC has the ability to charter, supervise, and regulate national banks and federal savings associations (and branches and agencies of foreign banks). The mission of the OCC is to make sure that banks treat all customers fairly and that they comply with applicable laws and regulations.

Individual state regulators

Each state has a government agency that regulates state-chartered banks, trust companies, and credit unions. These agencies often also monitor and regulate state business by insurance companies, bail bond agents, mortgage bankers, and more.

FDIC

The Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC) encourages public confidence in the US financial system by insuring some bank deposits up to $250,000. The FDIC insures a variety of savings accounts, including certain retirement accounts, joint accounts, employee benefit plan accounts, and revocable (and irrevocable) trust accounts. Consumers with FDIC-insured banks are protected in case of a bank failure.

FASB

The Financial Accounting Standards Board (FASB) establishes the standards for financial reporting in the US. FASB standards are known as "generally accepted accounting principles," or GAAP.

These standards are created to ensure accurate and acceptable accounting practices by corporations, which provide transparent information for investors. The standards help prevent accounting fraud.

In Canada

OSFI The Office of the Superintendent of Financial Institutions (OSFI) is an independent agency that reports to Parliament via the Minister of Finance. The OSFI regulates financial institutions and private pensions subject to federal oversight.

FRAS The Financial Reporting & Assurance Standards (FRAS) is the Canadian version of the US's Financial Accounting Standards Board. As in the US, the organization's purpose is to establish standards on accounting and auditing to protect the public interest

OCA The Office of Consumer Affairs (OCA) protects the interests of Canadian consumers and provides valuable information to help educate consumers about credit cards, debt, credit scores, collection agencies, and more.